

2026 FAST-TRACK INTERVIEW PLAN

A 42-day intensive roadmap for becoming interview-ready as a full-stack developer with AI capability.

GOAL: Be interview-ready in 42 days - focus on high-impact skills, not endless learning.

Your positioning

Full-Stack Developer + AI/DS graduate + AI integration

Primary stack: JavaScript, React, Node.js/Express, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, Git/GitHub, plus practical AI/LLM integration.

Priority order

Rank	Area	Why
1	DSA	Highest interview impact
2	JavaScript	Core language depth
3	React	Frontend interview readiness
4	Node.js	Backend/API readiness
5	SQL	Database interview readiness
6	Projects	Proof of practical ability
7	DBMS + OOP	CS fundamentals
8	OS + Networks	Interview-level basics
9	System Design basics	Enough for fresher/junior rounds
10	AI integration	Differentiator, not a distraction

Daily minimum

Time	Activity
2 hr	DSA
1 hr	JavaScript / React / Node
1 hr	SQL + CS fundamentals
1 hr	Projects + interview prep
30 min	Applications + referrals
30 min	Speaking / mock interview

WEEKS 1-3: CORE INTERVIEW SKILLS

Move fast. Learn only what you can immediately use in questions, coding, or projects.

WEEK 1 - DSA + JAVASCRIPT

DSA focus

- Arrays
- Strings
- HashMap
- Two pointers
- Sliding window
- Sorting
- Binary search
- Stack
- Queue

Target: 25-30 problems

JavaScript focus

- let / const / var
- Scope and hoisting
- Closures
- this
- Callbacks
- Promises
- async/await
- Event loop
- map/filter/reduce
- Destructuring
- Spread/rest
- Debouncing/throttling

Target: 30 common interview questions

WEEK 2 - REACT + DSA

React focus

- Components
- Props/state
- Hooks
- useEffect
- useMemo
- useCallback

- Context
- React Router
- Forms
- API calls
- Authentication
- Protected routes
- Error handling
- Performance

Target: Interview-ready explanations + small builds

DSA focus

- Linked List
- Recursion
- Basic backtracking
- Trees

Target: 25-30 more problems; 50-60 total

WEEK 3 - NODE + POSTGRESQL

Node / Express

- REST APIs
- Middleware
- JWT
- Authentication
- Authorization
- CORS
- Validation
- Error handling
- Pagination
- File upload
- Rate limiting
- API security

Target: Build/review one complete API

PostgreSQL

- SELECT
- JOIN
- GROUP BY
- HAVING
- Subqueries
- CTE
- Window functions

- Indexes
- Transactions
- Normalization
- ACID

Target: 30-40 SQL questions

Fast-track rule

Learn -> Solve -> Explain -> Repeat. Do not spend hours watching tutorials. After learning a topic, code it, answer questions on it, and explain it aloud.

WEEK 4 - CS FUNDAMENTALS + PROJECTS

Keep theory interview-level. Your projects should become strong enough to survive deep questioning.

DBMS

- Normalization
- ACID
- Transactions
- Indexing
- Joins
- SQL vs NoSQL

OOP

- Encapsulation
- Inheritance
- Polymorphism
- Abstraction
- Overloading
- Overriding
- SOLID basics

Operating Systems

- Process vs thread
- Deadlock
- Scheduling
- Virtual memory
- Paging
- Synchronization

Computer Networks

- HTTP/HTTPS
- TCP/UDP

- DNS
- REST
- Cookies
- Sessions
- JWT
- CORS

Project 1 - Kiwago

Make this your main full-stack project. Be ready to explain the architecture, database, authentication, order flow, and scaling decisions.

React	Express / Node	REST APIs	PostgreSQL
Authentication	Restaurant platform	Admin	Rider

Questions to prepare: Why PostgreSQL? How does authentication work? How are orders stored? How do you handle concurrent orders? How would you scale the system?

Project 2 - AI Resume Analyzer

Keep it small but polished: React -> Node -> AI API -> resume parsing -> job-description matching -> score + recommendations.

This gives you a strong story: an AI/DS graduate who can build production-style full-stack applications and integrate AI capabilities.

Do NOT build five new projects

Upgrade two projects, make the README professional, deploy them, and know every important design decision.

WEEKS 5-6: INTERVIEW MODE

Stop collecting courses. Start simulating interviews and converting preparation into applications.

WEEK 5 - MOCK INTERVIEW MODE

- 2 hours DSA daily, timed: solve, review, repeat.
- 1 hour technical questions: rotate JavaScript, React, Node, SQL, DBMS, OOP, OS, Networks.
- 1 hour project interview practice: explain architecture, contribution, hard problems, tradeoffs, and improvements.
- Record yourself answering common questions. Remove filler words and make answers structured.

WEEK 6 - APPLICATION + MOCK INTERVIEW SPRINT

- 1-2 hours DSA: revision and weak areas only.
- 1 hour mock interview daily.
- 1 hour applications across LinkedIn, Naukri, Wellfound, company career pages, and referrals.
- 30 minutes networking and referral outreach.

Application strategy

Start applying in Week 2. Do not wait until you feel fully ready. Early interviews expose weak areas and become preparation.

Metric	42-day target
DSA	100-120 problems
SQL	30-40 questions
JavaScript	30-40 interview questions
React	25-30 questions
Node.js	25-30 questions
CS fundamentals	100+ combined questions
Major projects	2
Mock interviews	10+
Targeted applications	200+
Referral attempts	50+

DSA - THE 80/20 VERSION

Your first target is 100-120 high-quality problems, not 300-500 random questions.

Topic	Target
Arrays	15
Strings	10
Hashing	10
Two pointers	8
Sliding window	8
Binary search	10
Stack / Queue	10
Linked List	10
Trees	15
Heap	8
Graphs	12
Basic DP	10

What to skip for now

- ✗ Learning five programming languages.
- ✗ Huge courses that take weeks.
- ✗ Building many new projects.
- ✗ Advanced ML before core interview skills are ready.
- ✗ Deep AWS/Kubernetes study.
- ✗ Waiting until you are "fully ready" before applying.

The interview-ready test

- ☐ Can you solve a medium DSA problem in a timed setting?
- ☐ Can you explain closures and the JavaScript event loop?
- ☐ Can you build and protect a REST API?
- ☐ Can you write joins, CTEs, window functions, and explain indexes?
- ☐ Can you explain your main project for 10 minutes without notes?
- ☐ Can you discuss tradeoffs and how you would scale the system?
- ☐ Can you answer clearly under pressure?

FINAL MINDSET Do not optimize for how much you study. Optimize for how quickly you become capable of clearing the next interview.